

Question ID: daad7c32

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear functions	Hard

Question

An object hangs from a spring. The formula $\ell = 30 + 2w$ relates the length ℓ , in centimeters, of the spring to the weight w , in newtons, of the object. Which of the following describes the meaning of the 2 in this context?

Answer

- A. The length, in centimeters, of the spring with no weight attached
- B. The weight, in newtons, of an object that will stretch the spring 30 centimeters
- C. The increase in the weight, in newtons, of the object for each one-centimeter increase in the length of the spring
- D. The increase in the length, in centimeters, of the spring for each one-newton increase in the weight of the object

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. The value 2 is multiplied by w , the weight of the object. When the weight is 0, the length is $30 + 2(0) = 30$ centimeters. If the weight increases by w newtons, the length increases by $2w$ centimeters, or 2 centimeters for each one-newton increase in weight.

Choice A is incorrect because this describes the value 30. Choice B is incorrect because 30 represents the length of the spring before it has been stretched. Choice C is incorrect because this describes the value w .